

{Less} command cheat sheet

USAGE

\$ less [OPTION...] FILENAME

DESCRIPTION

The less command is a Linux command-line utility that displays the contents of a file one page at a time. The less command is similar to the more command, but it has a number of powerful features that allows you to navigate back and forth through a text file, as well as doing some advance text searching. The name less comes from the phrase "*less is more*."

EXAMPLE

\$ less /var/logs/logs.txt

FORWARD SEARCH

- / Search forward for a pattern
- n Move forward for the next occurrence.
- N Move backward for the previous occurrence

BACKWARD SEARCH

- ? Search backward for a pattern.
- n Move backward for the next occurrence.
- N Move forward for the previous occurrence.

WORK WITH MULTIPLE FILES

- :e filename While viewing a file with less this command allows you to open/examine.
- :n Go to the next file.
- :p Go to the previous file.

SOME USEFUL OPTIONS

- N Displays line numbers on each line, allowing you to easily track the position of specific lines within the file.
- i Enables case-insensitive searching. When searching for a pattern using /, it matches both uppercase and lowercase versions of the letters.
- F Automatically exits less if the entire file can be displayed on one screen. Useful when viewing smaller files.
- p <pattern> Opens less and jumps directly to the first occurrence of the specified pattern in the file.
- S Chops long lines instead of wrapping them. This is helpful when viewing files with long lines and you prefer horizontal scrolling instead of wrapping.
- e Quits less automatically after reaching the end of the file.
- +<number> Starts less at the specified line number in the file.

NAVIGATION

- SPACE or CTRL+F Navigate forward one window
- b or CTRL+B Move backward one window
- d or CTRL+D Navigate forward half window
- u or CTRL+U Navigate backward half window
- j Navigate forward by one line
- 10j Navigate 10 lines forward.
- k Navigate backward by one line
- 10k Move 10 lines backward.
- G Go to the end of the file
- g Go to the start of the file
- q or ZZ Exit the less pager

OTHER COMMANDS

- F Follow the end of the file as more ines are added, similar to tail -f.
- m<any-lower-letter> Mark the current position with the letter the specified lower letter.
- '<lower-letter> Go to the marked position marked with the specified lower letter.
- &<pattern> Display only the matching lines, not all.
- v Open the current file in the default editor.
- CTRL+G or = Show the current file name along with line, byte, and percentage statistics.
- h Display help.



Less is More